



WEST CHESTER PRESCHOOL

A parent cooperative
preschool in West Chester,
Ohio

CURRICULUM GUIDE

THREE-YEAR-OLD CLASS · AGE 3

THREES CURRICULUM GUIDE

Young children learn in a variety of situations. In the Threes class students learn during circle time, at tables, and during play. These experiences expose them to many educational opportunities related to literacy and number sense, and introduce numerous conceptual ideas over the school year.



Aligned with the Ohio Department of Education Early Learning Content Standards. Page references (p. NN) point to that document.



READING

PHONEMIC AWARENESS & WORD RECOGNITION

- Recognize and name some letters
- Identify matching sounds and recognize rhymes in familiar stories, poems, songs, and words (cat/hat, dog/frog) (p. 12)
- Differentiate between sounds that are the same and different (environmental sounds, animal sounds, phonemes) (p. 12)
- Identify their own name in print (p. 13)
- Show reading fluency through phrasing, intonation, and expression in shared reading (p. 13)

VOCABULARY

- Understand the meaning of new words from the context of conversation, pictures, or concrete objects (p. 14)
- Communicate position and directional words (e.g., inside, outside, in front, behind) (p. 14)
- Name items in common categories (animals, colors, food, clothing, transportation) (p. 14)

READING PROCESS

- Hold books right-side up; know that we read pages front to back, top to bottom, and words left to right (p. 16)
- Respond to oral reading by commenting or questioning (p. 17)

READING APPLICATIONS

- Use pictures and illustrations to aid comprehension — informational text (p. 18)

- Participate in shared reading of repetitious or predictable text — literary text (p. 19)



WRITING

WRITING APPLICATIONS

- Play at writing from top to bottom, in horizontal rows (p. 21)

WRITING CONVENTIONS

- Print letters of their own name and other meaningful words with assistance, using mock letters and/or conventional print (p. 22)



COMMUNICATION

- Attend to speakers, stories, poems, and songs (p. 24)
- Begin to speak clearly and understandably to express ideas, feelings, and needs (p. 25)
- Present their own experiences, products, creations, or writing through language (p. 25)
- Follow simple oral directions (p. 24)
- Participate in the recitation of books, poems, chants, songs, and nursery rhymes (p. 25)



MATH

- Count to 10 in the context of daily activities (p. 29)
- Touch objects and say the number names when counting during activities and play (p. 29)
- Identify and name numerals 0–5 (p. 29)
- Identify, name, create, and describe common two-dimensional shapes (circles, triangles, rectangles, squares) (p. 31)
- Sort, order, and classify objects by one attribute (e.g., size, color, shape, use) (p. 32)



SOCIAL & EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Separate easily from parents
- Demonstrate self-confidence and willingly try new things
- Follow classroom rules and routines (p. 49)
- Transition between activities
- Demonstrate cooperative behaviors such as turn taking, sharing, comforting, and compromising (p. 41)
- Are considerate of others
- Respect authority



FINE MOTOR

- Use crayons
- Use scissors
- Mold clay



GROSS MOTOR

- Climb
- Walk a balance beam
- Catch a ball
- Jump



MUSIC & ART

- Participate during group singing
- Respond to rhythmic activities
- Identify colors
- Participate in art activities
- Identify the intended purpose of familiar tools (e.g., scissors, hammer, paint brush, cookie cutter) (p. 40)
- Demonstrate the safe use of tools such as scissors, hammers, and writing utensils, with adult guidance (p. 40)



CONCEPTUAL AREAS INTRODUCED DURING THE YEAR



SCIENCE & HEALTH

EARTH SCIENCE

Weather

Seasons

LIFE SCIENCE

Animals

Plants

Life cycles (e.g., butterflies)

PHYSICAL SCIENCE

Sensory experiences

HEALTH SCIENCE

Healthy habits (e.g., washing hands)

Dental health

Explore objects, organisms, and events using simple equipment (e.g., magnets and magnifiers).



SOCIAL STUDIES

HISTORY

Heritage (e.g., Shining Poster; Me: I Am Special)

CULTURE

Traditions

Holidays

GOVERNMENT

Classroom rules

Authority figures at home, school, and in the community (e.g., parents, teachers, police officers)

Community (e.g., post office, community helpers)